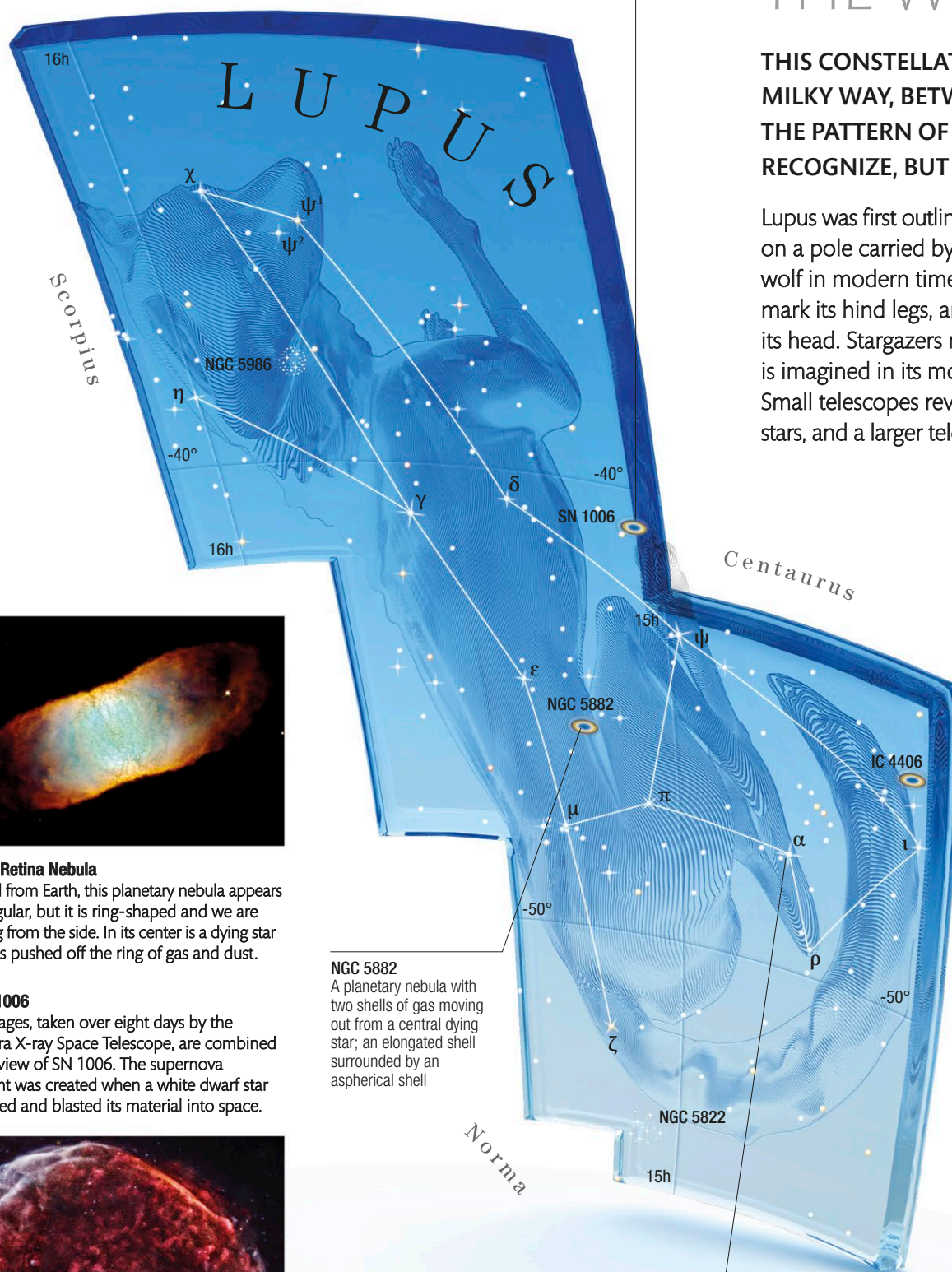


SN 1006

A supernova remnant about 60 light-years across and 7,000 light-years away. It is the remains of the brightest supernova in recorded history

Libra



LUPUS

THE WOLF

THIS CONSTELLATION LIES ON THE EDGE OF THE MILKY WAY, BETWEEN SCORPIUS AND CENTAURUS. THE PATTERN OF THE WOLF IS DIFFICULT TO RECOGNIZE, BUT IT CONTAINS STARS OF INTEREST.

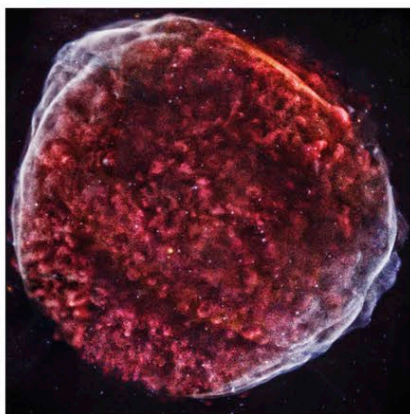
Lupus was first outlined as an unspecified wild animal impaled on a pole carried by Centaurus, but is drawn as a separate wolf in modern times. Its two brightest stars, Alpha and Beta, mark its hind legs, and the globular cluster NGC 5986 marks its head. Stargazers might find a wolf easier to picture if Alpha is imagined in its mouth, and Beta in the back of its neck. Small telescopes reveal that stars Kappa and Mu are double stars, and a larger telescope shows that Mu is really a triple star.

**△ The Retina Nebula**

Viewed from Earth, this planetary nebula appears rectangular, but it is ring-shaped and we are viewing from the side. In its center is a dying star that has pushed off the ring of gas and dust.

▽ SN 1006

Ten images, taken over eight days by the Chandra X-ray Space Telescope, are combined in this view of SN 1006. The supernova remnant was created when a white dwarf star exploded and blasted its material into space.

**NGC 5882**

A planetary nebula with two shells of gas moving out from a central dying star; an elongated shell surrounded by an aspherical shell

NGC 5822**Alpha Lupi**

At magnitude 2.3, this is the brightest star in Lupus. About ten times the mass of the Sun, its luminosity varies slightly in a seven-hour cycle

KEY DATA

Size ranking 46

Brightest stars Alpha (α) 2.3, Beta (β) 2.7

Genitive Lupi

Abbreviation Lup

Highest in sky at 10pm May–June

Fully visible 34°N–90°S



CHART 4

MAIN STARS

Alpha (α) Lupi

Blue giant star

☀ 2.3 ↔ 464 light-years

Beta (β) Lupi

Blue giant star

☀ 2.7 ↔ 383 light-years

Gamma (γ) Lupi

Blue giant star in a binary system

☀ 2.8 ↔ 421 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS**NGC 5882**

Asymmetrically shaped planetary nebula

NGC 5986

Globular cluster

The Retina Nebula (IC 4406)

Planetary nebula

SN 1006

Supernova remnant